coursera | MoMA

Seeing Through Photographs

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Introduction to Seeing Through Photographs

Module 2
One Subject, Many Perspectives

Module 3
Documents and the Documentary

Module 4
One and Another

Module 5
Constructing Narratives, Challenging Histories

Module 6
Pictures of People

Part I: Introduction
- Introduction to Module 6 — Reading • 2 min
- Artwork Spotlight: Katy Grannan's Portraits — Reading • 2 min
- Katy Grannan on Taking Portraits — Video • 3 min

Part II: Between Subject and Object
- Exploring Agency — Reading • 4 min
- Practical Scenario — Real-world application • 5 min
- Hear More: Susan Meiselas on Carnival Strippers, 1973–75 — Video • 5 min
- Self-Possession — Reading • 4 min

Part III: Individuals and Types
- Performing Identity — Reading • 7 min
- Practical Scenario — Real-world application • 5 min
- Hear More: Akram Zaatari on After They Got the Right to Arms. Fourteen young men posing with guns, early 1970s/2006 — Video • 6 min
- Hear More: Stephanie Syjuco on Cargo Cults, 2013–16 — Video • 2 min

Part IV: Strangers and Friends
- Loved Ones — Reading • 7 min
- Practical Scenario — Real-world application • 5 min
- Hear More: Tina Barney on Sunday New York Times, 1982 — Video • 1 min
- Hear More: Deana Lawson on Roxie and Raquel, 2010 — Video • 1 min
- Hear More: Maria Antelman on Puzzlers, 2020 — Video • 4 min

Part V: Review and Respond
- Practice Memory Check — Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%
- Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges — Reading • 10 min
- Optional Readings and Resources — Reading • 10 min

Module 7
Ocean of Images

Part I: Introduction
- Introduction to Module 7 — Reading • 3 min
- Sarah Meister on the Ocean of Images — Video • 2 min

Part II: Analogue Ancestors
- Before the Digital Wave — Reading • 5 min
- Hear More: Sarah Meister on Gertrudes Altschul. Lines and Tones. c. 1952 — Video • 1 min
- Appropriating Mass Media — Reading • 8 min
- Hear More: Eva Respini on Robert Heinecken. Are You Rea. 1964–68 — Video • 1 min
- Practical Scenario — Real-world application • 5 min
- Hear More: Martha Rosler on House Beautiful: Bringing the War Home, 1967–72 — Video • 2 min
- Hear More: Carmen Winant on My Birth, 2018 — Video • 2 min

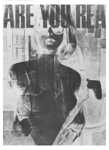
Part III: Digital Oceans
- Born Digital — Reading • 10 min
- Hear More: Thomas Ruff on jpeg msh01, 2004 — Video • 4 min
- Practical Scenario — Real-world application • 5 min
- Hear More: Anouk Kruithof on Subconscious Travelling, 2013 — Video • 4 min
- Hear More: Lucas Blalock on Strawberries, 2014–15 — Video • 3 min
- Hear More: David Horvitz on Mood Disorder, 2015 — Video • 3 min
- Hear More: Özlem Altın on Topography (of time, of body), 2019 — Video • 5 min

Part IV: Review and Respond
- Practice Memory Check — Practice Assignment • 30 min
- Optional Creative Challenge — Reading • 10 min
- Final Assignment — Graded Assignment • 30 min
- Optional Readings and Resources — Reading • 10 min
- End of Course Survey — Reading • 5 min

Appropriating Mass Media

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Robert Heinecken



Robert Heinecken. *Are You Rea*. 1964–68. Offset lithograph, 10 13/16 × 7 7/8" (27.4 × 20 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Mr. and Mrs. Clark Winter Fund. © 2020 The Robert Heinecken Trust

Are You Rea is a portfolio of 24 photographic prints Robert Heinecken made by placing pages from popular magazines on photographic paper and exposing them to light. The resulting prints register both the front and back of the pages, blending them into a single image. This print features the truncated text "Are You Rea[. . .]" above two overlapping images of women: one modeling a bra, and the other seated in a modern interior. Using source material from advertising, television, and pornography for much of his work, Heinecken critiques the manipulative intent behind such imagery. As he put it, the images "do not represent firsthand experiences, but are related to the perhaps more socially important manufactured experiences which are being created daily by the mass media."

Martha Rosler



Martha Rosler. *Red Stripe Kitchen* from the series *House Beautiful: Bringing the War Home*. c. 1967–72. Pigmented inkjet print (photomontage), printed 2011, 23 3/4 × 18 1/8" (60.3 × 46 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Committee on Photography and The Modern Women's Fund. © 2020 Martha Rosler

Martha Rosler made House Beautiful: Bringing the War Home in protest against the Vietnam War. The photomontages in this series seamlessly combine images of the war with advertisements and glossy illustrations of fashionable American home interiors, many published in the magazine *House Beautiful*. By conjoining images of war and domesticity so that their subjects appear to share the same space, Rosler alludes to the phrase "living room war," which was coined to describe the Vietnam War as the first major military conflict to be extensively televised. Rosler considered these images to be agitprop, or political propaganda meant to agitate viewers, and originally distributed them as Xeroxed flyers at anti-war demonstrations.

Luigi Ghirri



Luigi Ghirri. *Cardboard Landscapes*. 1971–73. 111 chromogenic color prints and offset lithographs in album, 9 13/16 × 10 1/4 × 1 15/16" (25 × 26 × 5 cm) overall. The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Gift of the artist

While working full time as a surveyor in 1970, Luigi Ghirri began to make his first photographs during vacations and on the weekends. Using posters, signs, objects, fragments, and other printed images found on the street, he created the series *Paesaggi di cartone*, or Cardboard Landscapes. When it was first exhibited in 1974, the series was accompanied by a modest paperback production comprising thirteen offset color reproductions. The publication featured a text by the critic Massimo Mussini in which he concludes, "The individual subsumed by mass culture does not find it aberrant to replace nature, the real, with the advertising message, made of cardboard."

Ghirri trimmed six of the reproductions from the exhibition publication and pasted them into an album documenting all the images he produced for the series. Over the course of fifty pages, the artist arranged 111 color prints, occasionally inscribing the pages with a ballpoint pen. Cardboard Landscapes demonstrates Ghirri's unrestrained approach to the medium of photography: pictures of pictures are interwoven with representations of "nature" and images that evoke the universe of "photography." These multiple, and sometimes indistinguishable, visual layers demonstrate Ghirri's open attitude toward the multitude of imagery found in his photos, as well as his interest in hybridity and multiplicity.

Carmen Winant



Carmen Winant. *My Birth*. 2018. Approx. 2,000 found papers and photographic prints with tape, dimensions variable. The Museum of Modern Art, New York. The Modern Women's Fund. © 2020 Carmen Winant

My Birth is composed of over two thousand images of women preparing for childbirth and in the process of labor. Winant is conscious of the ways the work of women is both visible and invisible. While the activities shown here are widespread and essential, pictures of them are not common, even in our image-saturated culture. The installation was motivated by Winant's own experience of giving birth: "Just a couple weeks after… I remember reading an interview with the artist Mierle Laderman Ukeles, and she was talking about how in 1968 after she gave birth, she was shocked that no one asked about it. She said something like, 'Weren't they curious about what it felt like to create life? But with no language, it was like I was mute.' And I wept when I read those words because I was undergoing a similar experience, having never recognized it for myself."

Winant sourced masses of material from publications dating back several decades that empowered women—including *Our Bodies, Ourselves*. She sifted through material at used bookstores and garage and estate sales and acquired more from women's healthcare workers and midwives. Winant pointed out, "The digital world is expanding and the analog world is contracting. Libraries are purging; it's an important time to be collecting." Though she organizes the images by category while working in her studio, the relationships that form between the components once they are installed on the wall are not necessarily obvious. Instead, they allow for multiple readings, some seemingly contradictory, and others complementary.

Lyle Ashton Harris



Lyle Ashton Harris. *The Watering Hole I-IX*. 1996. Nine chromogenic color prints, each 35 1/2 x 29" (90.2 x73.7 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Gift of Agnes Gund. © 2020 Lyle Ashton Harris



Lyle Ashton Harris. *The Watering Hole VII*. 1996. Chromogenic color print, 35 1/2 × 29" (90.2 × 73.7 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Gift of Agnes Gund. © 2020 Lyle Ashton Harris

Lyle Ashton Harris conceived the nine-panel photomontage, *The Watering Hole*, at the peak of the AIDS crisis. The work is an assortment of images appropriated from mass-media, including pictures of pop cultural icons; antique ethnographic postcards eroticizing and exoticizing black men; interracial pornography; and press and police photographs of mass-murderer Jeffrey Dahmer and his largely gay African American victims. Harris assembled these images on a wood paneled background along with handwritten Post-it notes and stenciled words featuring racially and sexually provocative phrases from magazines, films, and the artist's personal recollections—then photographed the compositions through red light. Harris alludes to the literal and figurative violence encoded in racism, stating, "The work was a way of looking at how communities are involved in the systematic consumption of the other, often the poor and the vulnerable."

Mark as completed

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